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Learn. Create. Connect.

AAW's 30th Annual International Symposium

The American Association of Woodturners – AAW – is the world's leading resource for woodturning information, inspiration and instruction. AAW's annual international symposium complements its expansive collection of woodturning educational publications and services. Each year, it offers woodturners an opportunity to learn new techniques, glean inspiration and connect with others who share their passion. AAW's 30th annual international symposium will be held at the Atlanta Convention Center at AmericasMart in Atlanta, Georgia, from 9–12 June, 2016.

Here are 10 reasons why you'll want to join the AAW and your woodturning colleagues in Atlanta…

AAW is turning 30!

The AAW has played a crucial role in the development of contemporary woodturning and wood art since 1986. We've led to a dramatic transformation of the craft over the past three decades. Together at the AAW symposium, we'll be able to celebrate this 30-year milestone and the dedicated people who got us started.

World-class demonstrations

For those who appreciate exceptional woodturning displays AAW offers three-and-a-half days of classroom-type demonstrations and panel discussions led by internationally known woodturners and veteran instructors. No other event offers as many opportunities to learn from the world's best turners. North American demonstrators include Sally Ault, Robin Costelle, Cynthia Carden Gibson, Michael Hosaluk, Beth Ireland, John Jordan, Dale Larson, David Marks, Jason Schneider, Mark Sfirri and Curt Theobald.

All skill levels welcome

Whether you're a beginner or a veteran woodturner, the AAW symposium has something for everyone. You'll be able to select from the broad range of demonstrations and panel discussions to focus on sessions that will enhance your experience wherever you are on your woodturning journey. You'll also take away knowledge, tips and techniques that will last a lifetime.

Avelino Samuel, Virgin Islands, and Neil Turner, Australia, conduct an intimate critique session at the 2015 AAW symposium

Christian Burchard demonstrates green wood hollow forms with madrone burl at the 2015 AAW symposium

Broad topic area appeal

For turners interested in special topic areas and in connecting with affinity groups the AAW has a wide assortment of learning areas including classic bowl turning, surface carving and embellishment, segmented turning and hollow vessels to name a few. Plus, its growing number of affinity groups offers huge diversity with segmented turners, ornamental turners, pen turners, multi-axis turners, women turners, disabled turners, and youth turners.

Barbara Dill demonstrates multi-axis turning at the 2015 AAW symposium

Excellent value

AAW's symposium packs in more high-quality learning opportunities for woodturners than any other event in the world. You can sign up early for discounted registration and special group rates at selected hotels. You'll receive a full-colour 150+ page handout book loaded with information, techniques and insights from demonstrators. Plus, the AAW's symposium Guidebook app for mobile devices will be available again this year so you can have the rotations, demonstrators, floor plans and messaging at your fingertips.

Huge woodturning trade show

Anyone who likes to see the latest and greatest woodturning products up close and in action should head to the AAW's

FROM THE FORUM

'Large Dish' by SUSIE, made from sycamore (*Acer pseudoplatanus*) burr at 415mm diameter

'Ooops, They Cracked' by georg

'Spalted Beech' by Dunkhooper, at 230 x 100mm

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